

ARSPI-Net: An Event-Driven Reservoir–Graph Substrate for Embodied Affective EEG Perception

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Abstract—We present ARSPI-Net (Affective Reservoir–Spike Processing and Inference Network), a brain-inspired event-driven reservoir–graph substrate that transforms noisy affective electroencephalography (EEG) into a set of operationally distinct neural evidence streams and evaluates those streams as perceptual channels for a simulated embodied agent. The substrate is anchored in concrete neural mechanisms: a fixed leaky integrate-and-fire (LIF) spiking reservoir, a binned spike-count (BSC₆) event-driven code, an electrode-level temporal phase-locking (tPLV) graph, and a structure–function coupling readout $\kappa = \|C\|_F / \sqrt{pq}$. These produce four evidence streams: a spike-coded embedding E , dynamical descriptors D , graph-topological descriptors T , and a coupling block C . On 633 trial-averaged subject–condition observations from 211 adults under subject-grouped cross-validation across five seeds, a mechanism ablation with negative controls separates the streams: balanced accuracy is highest for the embedding-containing configurations ($E+D+T$, 0.481) and the band-power baseline (0.485), the standalone D , T , and C streams are lower but above the three-class chance level, and a shuffled-label control collapses to chance; an independent permutation–FDR protocol corroborates the ordering. The streams are not linear duplicates (largest CKA(E, D) = 0.31), and a 5,000-permutation electrode-shuffle null on κ is rejected in 33.5% of observations. We characterise the streams under four perturbation families—temporal jitter, amplitude noise, channel dropout, and graph edge perturbation—and report their operating regimes rather than a single endpoint. Finally, an explicitly defined expected-free-energy controller uses the substrate as a perceptual estimator in a simulated closed-loop affective-control task with action-determined transition noise; against passive, random, pragmatic-only, epistemic-only, and perfect-perception oracle policies, the controller reaches and confirms a target affective state but shows no advantage over pragmatic control, an operating-regime result. Clinical labels are used only as exploratory contextual validation and are bounded by a false-discovery-rate result; no diagnostic claim is made. All results are restricted to the measured SHAPE ERP regime and are not a universal claim about EEG graph neural networks.

Index Terms—EEG, neuromorphic computing, spiking neural networks, liquid state machines, reservoir computing, neural coding, predictive coding, sequential evidence accumulation, embodied AI, perception–action loops, structure–function coupling, layer ablation.

I. INTRODUCTION

EEG offers millisecond-scale access to neural activity, but scalp recordings are noisy, indirect, and subject-dependent. For an embodied agent that must perceive and act on affective state, the central engineering problem is the extraction of

usable neural evidence from this partially observed, nonstationary signal. We treat the affective event-related potential (ERP) as the output of a biological dynamical system and ask how an event-driven, brain-inspired substrate can transform it into evidence streams whose reliability can be measured under perturbation and used to drive perception under uncertainty. This is a neuromorphic signal-processing question, not a question of psychology or diagnosis. A single endpoint classifier is useful but blunt: it cannot tell us which part of a staged substrate carries the signal, how that signal degrades under realistic measurement perturbations, or whether two intermediate representations measure the same thing under different names.

Recent IEEE biomedical work sets a clear bar. Compact convolutional baselines such as EEGNet [6], EEG graph networks [8], [10], spiking–graph hybrids [9], and multimodal attention models [11], [12] are defended through cross-subject protocols, ablations, and module-level metrics rather than one accuracy number. The present manuscript follows that practice for ARSPI-Net (Affective Reservoir–Spike Processing and Inference Network), a staged neuromorphic architecture for clinical affective EEG.

ARSPI-Net produces four feature families per observation: a reservoir spike embedding E , dynamical descriptors D , electrode-level topological descriptors T , and structure–function coupling descriptors C . Earlier ARSPI-Net work characterised subject-covariance geometry and a four-level interpretability taxonomy. The question here is more architectural. Do E , D , T , and C behave as different things, or are they redundant relabellings of the same thing?

We adopt a measurement-oriented definition. *Operational distinctness* is empirical non-equivalence of layers under a fixed evaluation protocol. A block is operationally distinct if it differs in predictive sufficiency, in incremental utility, in label-specific sensitivity, or in representational redundancy. The definition does not assume the blocks track independent biological mechanisms. It asks whether they behave like different signal-processing views of one EEG response.

The audit draws on three properties of this study. The data are a 211-subject affective EEG cohort with five overlapping psychiatric labels and per-subject comorbidity counts, an unusually clinically rich resource for affective EEG research. The architecture decomposes the staged pipeline into four blocks, each tied to a named neural mechanism rather than treated as a black-box feature extractor. The audit protocol combines subject-respecting permutation inference, FDR correction, redundancy under centered-kernel alignment [17], an electrode-permutation null on the coupling readout, and a sequential-

Inferential results use subject-respecting permutation tests at $n_{\text{perm}} = 200$. Clinical contrasts are reported with Benjamini–Hochberg correction across the 30 diagnosis $\times$ configuration cells; no clinical contrast survived correction at $\alpha = 0.05$, so clinical results are presented as weak-signal sensitivity, not biomarker validation.

decision simulation that places the four blocks in an embodied perception loop. The simulation is positioned as a precursor to active inference [29]–[31], not as an instantiation: it is closed-loop on the belief side, open-loop on the environment side.

This paper makes four bounded technical contributions. First, it specifies an event-driven reservoir–graph substrate in which each evidence stream is anchored to a named neural mechanism—LIF spiking, BSC₆ event-driven coding, tPLV connectivity, and κ structure–function coupling—with an explicit mathematical observable for each. Second, it establishes the operational distinctness of the streams through a mechanism ablation (A0–A9) with negative controls, distinguishing predictive utility (whether a stream raises endpoint accuracy) from measurement utility (whether a stream exposes structure the others do not). Third, it quantifies the perturbation robustness of the streams under temporal jitter, amplitude noise, channel dropout, and graph edge perturbation, reporting operating regimes rather than a single endpoint. Fourth, it evaluates the streams as perceptual channels for a simulated embodied affective-control loop driven by an explicitly defined expected-free-energy controller, compared against passive, random, pragmatic-only, epistemic-only, and oracle baselines. Throughout, dataset provenance and quality control are reported as verifiable facts, clinical labels are used only as exploratory validation structure bounded by a false-discovery-rate result, and outputs are privacy-preserving and reproducible.

II. RELATED WORK AND NOVELTY BOUNDARY

A. EEG Classification and Biomedical Evaluation Norms

Modern EEG classification papers compare new representations against compact convolutional baselines, spectral features, recurrent models, and graph models [6]–[8]. In TNSRE, Gong *et al.* integrated spike encoding, adaptive graph convolution, and spike-based LSTM units for EEG-BCI and reported cross-subject evaluation, parameter analysis, and confusion matrices [9]. In JBHI, Guo *et al.* reported a multimodal attention network for EEG, EDA, and PPG fatigue detection with cross-subject experiments and modality comparisons [11]. The pattern is the same in both venues: architecture, mathematical definition, controlled ablation, multiple metrics, claim-bounded clinical discussion, and reproducible outputs. The present paper adopts that standard.

B. Brain-Inspired and Spiking Architectures for Embodied Use

The brain-inspired computing tradition treats biophysical neuron and synapse models as a substrate for computation rather than as an analogy. The leaky integrate-and-fire neuron descends from the Hodgkin–Huxley membrane equations [4] as an idealised dynamical reduction. Liquid state machines [1] and echo state networks [2] use a fixed recurrent reservoir as a high-dimensional projection from which simple readouts learn; the broader reservoir computing programme is reviewed in Lukoševičius and Jaeger [3]. Spiking learning rules grounded in synaptic biology, such as STDP [32], support competitive

TABLE I
NOVELTY BOUNDARY RELATIVE TO PRIOR ARSPI-NET MANUSCRIPTS

SPL geometry paper	Interpretability paper	Present paper
Where is condition signal buried?	What can be inspected?	What does each layer do?
Subject/condition variance	Four-level interpretability taxonomy	Layer-wise ablation of E, D, T, C
Geometry of nuisance variation	Explanation scope	Operational role and non-equivalence

unsupervised feature learning in restricted settings [33]. Neuromorphic substrates such as Loihi [34] and SpiNNaker [35] run these primitives at orders-of-magnitude lower energy than conventional accelerators. ARSPI-Net inherits this lineage and tries to make the biophysical anchoring explicit at every block: a fixed LIF reservoir, a spike-count code, a phase-locking topology, and a coupling readout with a permutation null.

C. Graph and Spiking EEG Models

Graph neural networks have been applied to emotion recognition, motor imagery, and neurological or psychiatric labels from EEG. Klepl *et al.* note that EEG-GNN methods diverge in node features, graph construction, graph convolution, pooling, and readout choices [8]. Spiking methods add temporal event-based computation and dynamical state variables [1], [9]. ARSPI-Net departs from end-to-end EEG classifiers by treating the reservoir as a fixed nonlinear measurement operator whose outputs feed several downstream descriptors rather than one classification head.

D. Novelty Boundary Relative to Prior ARSPI-Net Work

The novelty of this paper is not the existence of ARSPI-Net, nor the claim that ARSPI-Net is interpretable. The unique question is whether the four feature families generated by ARSPI-Net behave as distinct operational layers. Table I summarises this boundary.

III. ARSPI-NET LAYER FORMULATION

A. Input Representation

Let

$$X_s^{(c)} \in \mathbb{R}^{N_{ch} \times T}, \quad N_{ch} = 34, \quad (1)$$

denote the preprocessed event-related EEG response for subject s under condition $c \in \{\text{negative, neutral, pleasant}\}$. The affective task uses subject-condition observations directly. Clinical-label analyses average each feature family over the available conditions per subject.

B. Reservoir Dynamics and Spike Embedding

Each channel is fed independently into a fixed LIF reservoir whose discrete-time update is

$$\mathbf{u}_{t+1} = \beta \mathbf{u}_t + W_{in} x_t + W_{rec} \mathbf{z}_t - \mathbf{r}_t, \quad (2)$$

with spike emission

$$\mathbf{z}_{t+1} = H(\mathbf{u}_{t+1} - \theta), \quad (3)$$

where $H(\cdot)$ is the Heaviside step function, $\beta = 0.05$ is the membrane decay, $\theta = 0.5$ is the threshold, W_{in} and W_{rec} are Xavier-initialised input and recurrent matrices, and the reservoir size is $N_{res} = 256$. The recurrent matrix is rescaled so that its largest eigenvalue magnitude is 0.9. Spike counts are pooled into $n_{bins} = 6$ non-overlapping windows over the response interval $t \in [10, 70]$ to form the BSC_6 feature, and the per-channel BSC_6 vector is PCA-compressed to 64 components. The full embedding for a subject-condition observation is

$$E_s^{(c)} = [h_1 \| h_2 \| \dots \| h_{34}] \in \mathbb{R}^{2176}, \quad (4)$$

where $h_v \in \mathbb{R}^{64}$ is the channel-level embedding.

C. Dynamical, Topological, and Coupling Blocks

The dynamical block D contains reservoir-response descriptors per channel. The topological block T summarises electrode-level connectivity as a temporal phase-locking matrix and reduces it to two per-electrode summaries (mean strength and clustering). For per-channel matrices $D_s \in \mathbb{R}^{34 \times p}$ and $T_s \in \mathbb{R}^{34 \times q}$, the rank-correlation coupling matrix is

$$K_s = \text{corr}_\rho(D_s, T_s) \in \mathbb{R}^{p \times q} \quad (5)$$

and the coupling magnitude is

$$\kappa_s = \frac{\|K_s\|_F}{\sqrt{pq}}. \quad (6)$$

The block C contains κ_s alongside signed strength and clustering coupling summaries.

D. Operational Distinctness Criteria

For families $L_i, L_j \in \{E, D, T, C\}$ and target Y , the performance contrast is

$$\Delta_{ij}(Y) = \mathcal{M}(f(L_i), Y) - \mathcal{M}(f(L_j), Y), \quad (7)$$

with $\mathcal{M}$ either balanced accuracy or ROC-AUC and f a fixed L2-regularised logistic readout. The incremental utility relative to a baseline L_b is

$$\Gamma_i(Y|L_b) = \mathcal{M}(f([L_b \| L_i]), Y) - \mathcal{M}(f(L_b), Y). \quad (8)$$

Redundancy is assessed using linear centered-kernel alignment,

$$\text{CKA}(X, Y) = \frac{\|X_c^\top Y_c\|_F^2}{\|X_c^\top X_c\|_F \|Y_c^\top Y_c\|_F}, \quad (9)$$

with X_c and Y_c column-centered [17].

IV. BRAIN-INSPIRED MECHANISMS AND EMBODIED INTERPRETATION

The blocks of ARSPI-Net each have a named neural correlate. This section states the correlate, the implementation choice, and what each choice rules out, so the reader can treat the architecture as a sequence of physiologically motivated transformations rather than a stack of feature extractors. Table II summarises the mapping from each neural principle to its ARSPI-Net implementation, the computational object it produces, the observable it exposes, and its relevance to an embodied agent.

A. LIF Spiking Reservoir as a Recurrent Cortical Substrate

The reservoir realised by (2)–(3) is a fixed leaky integrate-and-fire network. The neuron model is the canonical biophysical reduction of the Hodgkin–Huxley axon [4]: a sub-threshold membrane that integrates synaptic drive, decays toward rest, fires when the integrated potential crosses threshold, and resets. With $\beta = 0.05$ the decay constant places the reservoir in the temporal regime that liquid state machines use for transient projection of input streams [1]. The recurrent matrix is held at spectral radius 0.9, just below the marginal-stability boundary at which a recurrent network’s transient response becomes long enough to support readout while remaining contractive on average [2], [5]. The reservoir is not trained. The classifier on the readout side is.

The fixed-reservoir choice is deliberate. Cortical micro-circuits do not appear to learn their recurrent connectivity through end-to-end gradient descent, and reservoir computing is one of the few tractable models that respects this [3]. Holding the reservoir fixed also forces every measurement and inference claim to come from properties of the recurrent dynamics themselves rather than from a classifier learning to compensate for a poorly chosen substrate. The price is that we cannot, within this paper, attribute clinical signal to plastic synaptic adaptation; that question is one of the directions in Section VII-E.

B. BSC_6 as an Event-Driven Code

The embedding E in (4) is built from binned spike counts over $n_{bins} = 6$ windows of the post-stimulus interval $t \in [10, 70]$. The choice rests on three properties. First, BSC_6 is event-driven. The representation is read off spikes, not membrane traces, and the classifier never touches a continuous neuronal state. Second, the encoding window starts a small distance after stimulus onset and ends well before the stimulus offset, covering the temporal interval where ERP components such as P200, N200, and the early portion of P300 are expressed. The bins are coarse enough to be robust to small temporal jitter but fine enough to preserve coarse temporal structure within the response. Third, the format is hardware-friendly: spike counts over fixed time windows are precisely the operation that on-chip event counters provide on Loihi [34] and SpiNNaker [35], and binned spike-count classifiers have been shown to support unsupervised digit recognition [33]. PCA compression to 64 per channel gives a fixed-length representation that the downstream readout consumes without retraining the reservoir.

C. tPLV Connectivity as Cortical Network Organisation

The topological block T is derived from per-observation 34×34 temporal phase-locking value matrices [23]. PLV measures inter-electrode phase consistency across trials and is one of the standard tools in EEG functional connectivity. Computed within the event-related response window, tPLV captures the connectivity that is in force during the task rather than during rest, mitigating the stationarity concerns that follow from full-trace PLV estimates. The matrix is reduced

TABLE II
NEURAL MECHANISMS IMPLEMENTED BY ARSPI-NET, EACH ANCHORED TO A CONCRETE COMPUTATIONAL OBJECT AND A MEASURED OBSERVABLE.

Neural principle	Implementation	Computational object	Measured observable	Relevance to embodied AI
Event-driven coding	BSC ₆ binning	temporal-bin count vector	bin evidence	sparse perceptual observation
Recurrent cortical dynamics	LIF reservoir	reservoir state trajectory	embedding E	nonlinear temporal transformation
Temporal state statistics	descriptor block D	trajectory descriptors	variance, autocorrelation, complexity	dynamical evidence stream
Functional connectivity	tPLV graph	adjacency / graph operator	topology descriptors T	spatial dependency
Structure-function coupling	κ	coupling readout	shuffle-null significance	systems-level coordination
Embodied perception	posterior update + policy	belief state	entropy, success, steps	closed-loop perceptual utility

to two per-electrode summaries, mean strength and clustering. Both belong to the established graph-theoretic vocabulary of brain network analysis [24], and both have a direct biological reading: strength tracks how synchronised an electrode is with the rest of the head, while clustering tracks whether its synchronised neighbours are themselves synchronised. The reduction loses information by design. We trade pairwise resolution for a per-channel descriptor compatible with the embedding shape used by the other blocks.

D. Structure–Function Coupling κ

The coupling readout (6) measures whether a subject’s per-electrode dynamical signature (D) and topological signature (T) co-vary across electrodes. It is a single non-negative scalar bounded above by 1, computed per subject-condition pair, and admits an electrode-permutation null. Structure–function coupling is a recurring quantity in network neuroscience, where it indexes the degree to which functional patterns line up with the structural backbone [25]–[27]. The use here is closer to a within-subject signature than to a population-level claim: κ asks whether one subject’s local electrode dynamics and the same subject’s electrode-level network position are coordinated, and the permutation null asks whether the coordination is more than would arise from chance electrode labelling. The block C embeds κ alongside signed strength and clustering coupling.

E. Sequential Evidence Accumulation

The four streams E , D , T , and $E + D + T$ are interpreted as operationally distinct sub-systems available to an embodied agent. Section VI-D instantiates this as a sequential-evidence-accumulation simulation. The simulation is closed-loop on the belief side and open-loop on the environment side: the agent’s posterior updates over time, but its action selection does not modify the stimulus stream. We treat the setup as a sequential-decision precursor to active inference [29]–[31] rather than as an active-inference implementation. The agent maintains a Dirichlet posterior $\text{Dir}(\alpha_t)$ over a held-out subject’s affective response distribution. At each step it picks one of the four feature-stream policies and updates the posterior under the soft observation

$$\alpha_{t+1} = \alpha_t + \mathbf{p}_{\theta_a}(x_t), \quad (10)$$

where $\mathbf{p}_{\theta_a}(x_t)$ is the policy- a classifier’s class-probability vector for the EEG observation x_t . Expected information gain is the KL divergence of the predictive distribution before and after the update. Comparing the four fixed-policy agents against a uniform-random meta-policy and a greedy-EIG meta-policy gives a sequential-decision counterpart to the offline ablation: instead of asking which feature set maximises a held-out accuracy, we ask which feature stream most rapidly reduces an agent’s posterior uncertainty over the perceived class of its environment. The setup is a perception loop on the belief side and makes the layer-utility question falsifiable in a sequential frame; the environment-side openness is the gap that a full active-inference implementation would close.

V. EXPERIMENTAL PROTOCOL

A. Data, Splitting, and Privacy

The reporting run uses 633 subject-condition observations from 211 community-recruited adults, exactly balanced across the three affective conditions (negative, neutral, pleasant). Clinical-label analyses use 206 subjects with available SUD, MDD, PTSD, GAD, and ADHD labels. Comorbidity is the rule rather than the exception in this cohort: most subjects carry more than one label, and the analyses below use comorbidity counts as a covariate where appropriate. All prediction-level artifacts use hashed subject identifiers. Raw EEG, clinical metadata, and feature pickles are not committed to the reporting repository.

Table III summarises the protocol. The architecture-level figures of the pipeline are reproduced from prior ARSPI-Net work; the analytical figures are generated from the corrected reporting outputs.

B. Source Figures and New Figures

Two prior-work source figures are retained to define the ARSPI-Net architecture and the BSC₆ embedding lineage. New figures are generated from the corrected reporting outputs.

C. Feature Blocks and Diagnostics

Table IV lists the evaluated blocks. A diagnostic was run before interpretation. The corrected embedding E has shape

TABLE III
SUBJECT-LEVEL REPORTING PROTOCOL

Stage	Input	Operation	Output / Control
Data	211 subjects, 633 subject-condition EEG observations	Condition-level affective analysis; subject-level clinical analysis	Three affective classes; 206 subjects with clinical labels
Feature diagnostics	BandPower, E , D , T , C	Check finite values, ranks, zero fractions, constant columns	Corrected E block nonzero with rank 632; all blocks nondegenerate
Affective ablation	A0–A9 feature configurations	10-fold subject-grouped CV with train-fold-only scaling	Balanced accuracy, macro ROC-AUC, macro-F1, predictions, confusion matrices
Clinical sensitivity	C1–C6 subject-average features	Binary logistic readout per clinical label	Exploratory clinical-label sensitivity, not diagnostic validation
Reproducibility	Reporting repository	Hashed subject IDs and manifest	No raw EEG, clinical CSV, direct IDs, or pickles committed

ARSPI-Net Pipeline: From Raw EEG to Graph-Based Clinical Analysis

Row 1: Multichannel EEG input (211 subjects $\times$ 3 conditions). Row 2: LIF reservoir transformation (EEG $\rightarrow$ spikes $\rightarrow$ BSCs $\rightarrow$ PCA-64). Row 3: Graph construction and inter-channel structure.

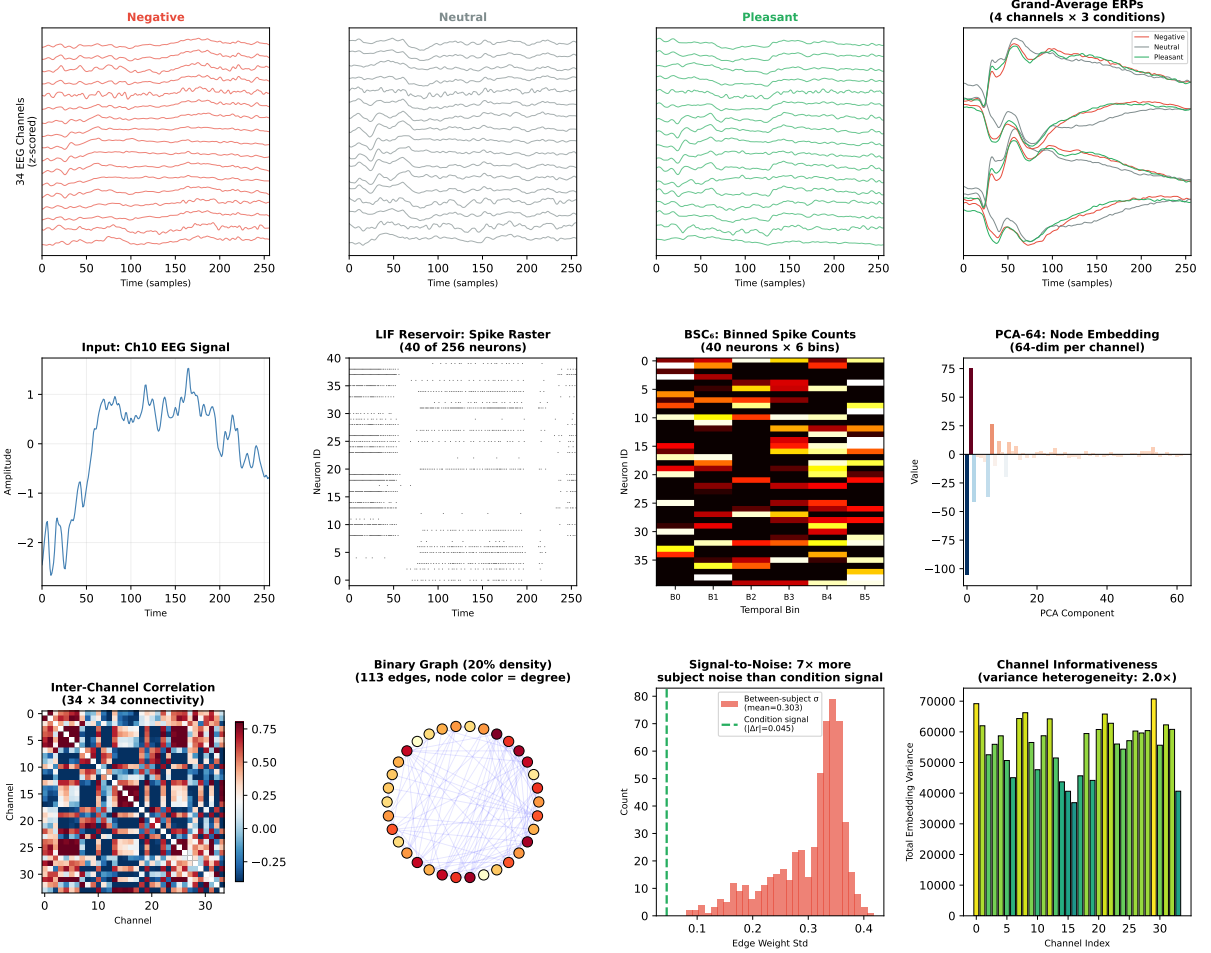


Fig. 1. Source ARSPI-Net pipeline overview reproduced from prior work. The figure defines the staged architecture whose layers are ablated in this manuscript.

(633,2176), no constant columns, zero fraction 0, approximate standardised rank 632, and median row norm 224.61. The diagnostic is reported because an earlier local input file contained a zero-valued embedding tensor; the corrected pickle is used throughout.

D. Ablation Matrices

Affective classification used the A0–A9 configurations. The classifier is L2-regularised logistic regression with train-fold-only standardisation under a 10-fold StratifiedGroupKFold subject separation. Clinical-label sensitivity used the C1–C6

BSC₆ Feature Structure on Real SHAPE EEG (N=211, 34 channels × 256 neurons × 6 bins)
The reservoir transforms EEG into a 52,224-dimensional spike representation with 47.4% sparsity.
Condition effects are significant in 23/34 channels and all 6 temporal bins ($p < 0.0001$).

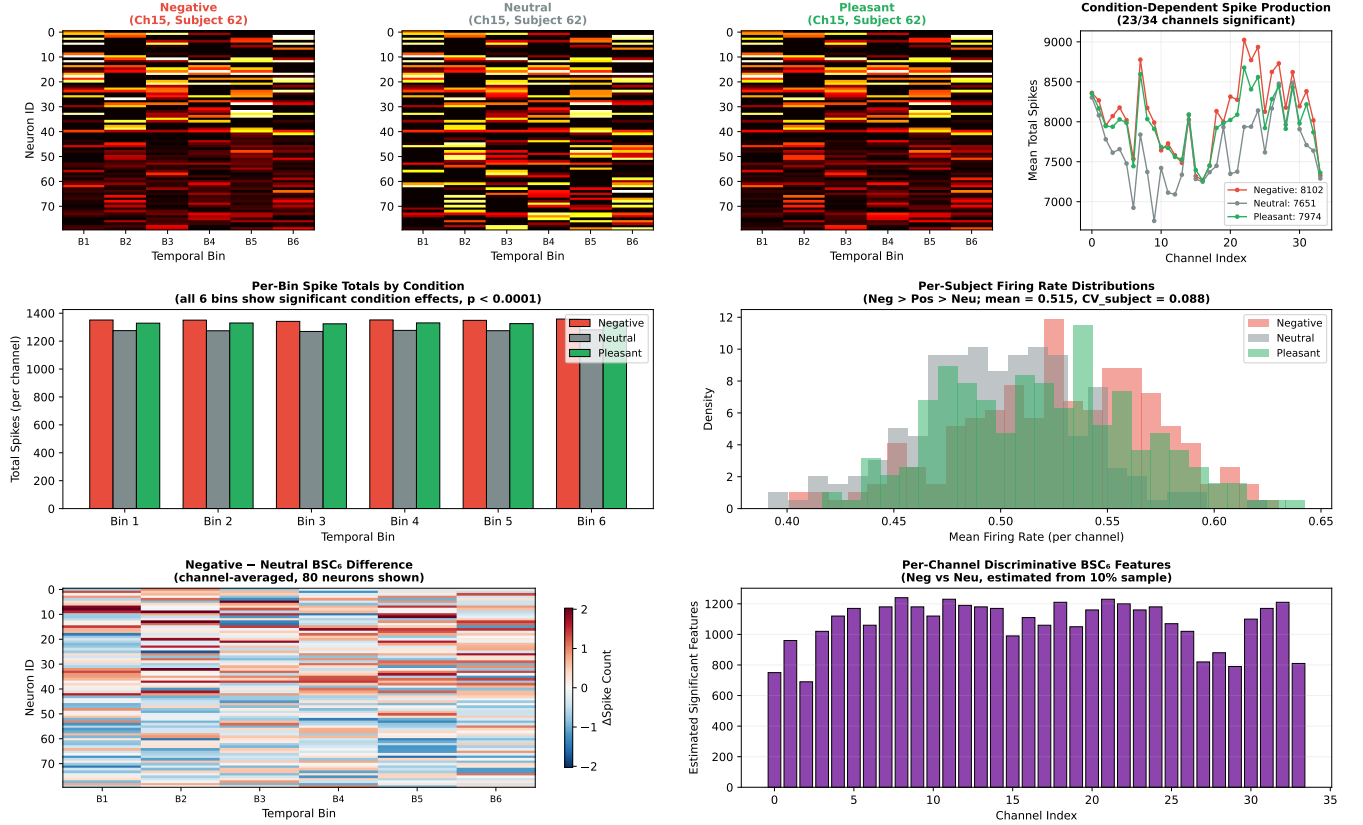


Fig. 2. Source BSC₆ feature-structure figure for real SHAPE EEG, reproduced from prior ARSPI-Net work. The quantitative results in this paper are generated from the corrected reporting pipeline, not transcribed from this source figure.

TABLE IV
FEATURE FAMILIES USED IN THE OPERATIONAL-DISTINCTNESS ANALYSIS

Block	Dimension	Source	Operational role
BandPower	170	Spectral features	Conventional frequency-domain comparator
E	2176	BSC ₆ /PCA-64 reservoir embedding	Temporal spike representation
D	238	Reservoir trajectory descriptors	Dynamical response characterization
T	68	Graph-topological descriptors	Spatial organization across electrodes
C	3	Structure-function coupling	Alignment of dynamics and topology

configurations at the subject level with the same logistic readout. Linear separability is the deliberate choice, because operational distinctness is a property of the feature spaces under a fixed read-out, not of an unconstrained nonlinear endpoint model. The optimisation is

$$\hat{\theta} = \arg \min_{\theta} \left[- \sum_{i=1}^n \log p_{\theta}(y_i | x_i) + \lambda \|\theta\|_2^2 \right] \quad (11)$$

and the primary metric is balanced accuracy

$$\text{BA} = \frac{1}{K} \sum_{k=1}^K \frac{TP_k}{TP_k + FN_k} \quad (12)$$

with $K = 2$ for clinical-label sensitivity and $K = 3$ for affective classification.

VI. RESULTS

We organise the evidence as one argument over four pillars: (A) dataset provenance and the computational objects the substrate produces; (B) the reservoir-graph mechanism ablation; (C) perturbation robustness and operating regimes; and (D) the simulated embodied affective-control loop. The primary ablation is the multi-seed mechanism ablation of Section VI-B; an independent ten-fold permutation-FDR protocol corroborates it, and that protocol together with the secondary clinical, redundancy, and comorbidity analyses is preserved in the supplementary technical version. Every main-text quantity maps to a script, input fingerprint, output table, and manifest entry in the reproduction map.

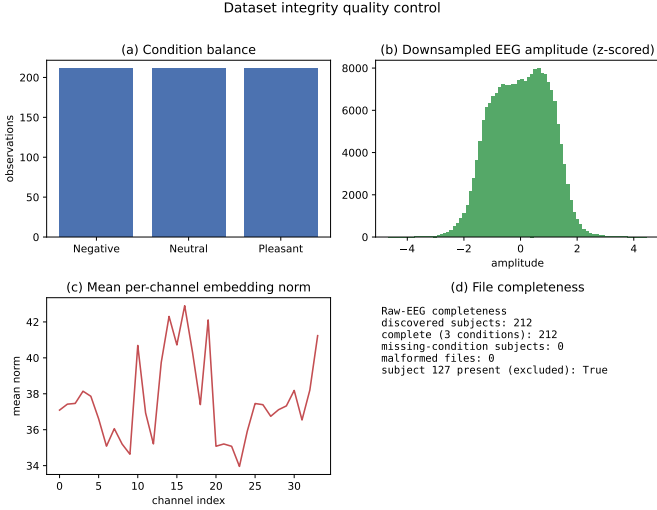


Fig. 3. Dataset integrity quality control: condition balance, downsampled-EEG amplitude distribution, per-channel embedding-norm consistency, and raw-file completeness. The figure plots measured integrity properties; subject identifiers are not exposed.

A. Dataset Provenance and Observed Computational Objects

The data are trial-averaged event-related EEG from 211 community-recruited adults (subject 127 excluded for a recording anomaly), giving 633 subject–condition observations balanced across Negative, Neutral, and Pleasant. Provenance, access conditions, and the subject-grouped split protocol are summarised in the reproducibility panel (Table VII); numerical-validity and completeness checks are shown in Fig. 3. Subject-level data are held in a restricted research environment, and only aggregate or hashed outputs are reported.

Fig. 4 surfaces the computational objects the substrate produces, for one exemplar per affective class: the LIF spike raster and membrane trajectory that generate the embedding E (panels a–b), the per-class 34×34 tPLV connectivity that defines the graph block T (panel c), and the BSC_6 projection that defines the event-driven code (panel d). Structure–function coupling is summarised by $\kappa = \|C\|_F / \sqrt{pq}$: across the 633 observations the mean is 0.250 (sd 0.115), and a 5,000-permutation electrode-shuffle null is rejected at $p < 0.05$ in 33.5% of observations, so a non-trivial subset of subjects show coordination above a randomised electrode labelling. Subject-mean κ is uncorrelated with per-subject classification accuracy ($\rho = 0.01$), behaving as a complementary systems-level readout rather than a proxy for predictive sufficiency.

B. Reservoir–Graph Mechanism Ablation

The primary ablation evaluates configurations A0–A9 under subject-grouped cross-validation across five seeds, with bootstrap intervals and two negative controls (Table V, Fig. 5). Balanced accuracy is highest for the spectral band-power baseline (A0, 0.485) and the embedding-containing configurations ($E+D+T$ 0.481, $E+D+T+C$ 0.481, $E+D$ 0.478, E 0.463); the standalone dynamical, topological, and coupling streams are lower (D 0.432, C 0.368, T 0.355) but remain above the three-class chance level of 0.333. The shuffled-label control

collapses to chance (0.335), confirming the protocol. An independent ten-fold permutation–FDR protocol corroborates the ordering: eight of ten configurations exceed a subject-respecting permutation null, with standalone T and C the two that do not.

The reading is operational differentiation, not classifier superiority. The embedding carries most of the affective-classification signal, but D , T , and C are not linear duplicates of it—the largest pairwise centred-kernel alignment is $CKA(E, D) = 0.31$ —and they expose dynamical, topological, and coupling structure that the embedding alone does not. Clinical labels are used only as exploratory contextual validation: per-diagnosis balanced accuracies are near chance (0.49–0.53 across SUD, MDD, PTSD, GAD, ADHD) and no contrast survives Benjamini–Hochberg correction across the 30 diagnosis $\times$ configuration cells; no diagnostic or clinical-biomarker claim is made. The clinical-sensitivity, redundancy, and comorbidity-adjusted analyses are reported in full in the supplementary technical version.

C. Perturbation Robustness and Operating Regimes

We characterise each evidence stream under four perturbation families—temporal jitter, amplitude noise, channel dropout, and graph edge perturbation—applied at the representation level across all ten configurations, with a bounded raw-signal diagnostic (subset scope recorded in the run manifest) that recomputes a reservoir embedding within fold. Fig. 6 reports the degradation profiles. The objective is to report the operating regime of each stream rather than a single endpoint: the embedding-containing configurations retain the most discriminative information under amplitude noise and channel dropout, while the graph-derived stream degrades fastest under graph edge perturbation, locating the boundary at which topological evidence becomes unreliable.

A classical ERP-amplitude baseline (windowed $P1$ –LPP features) provides a static discrimination anchor, reaching 67.2% balanced accuracy on the three-class task and exceeding ARSPI-Net under a static readout. The classical ERP baseline provides a strong static discrimination anchor; ARSPI-Net is evaluated as a reservoir–graph measurement substrate—decomposing the response into operationally distinct, perturbation-characterised evidence streams with simulated embodied utility—rather than as a replacement for ERP amplitude features in static classification. The full static comparison is preserved in the supplementary technical version.

D. Simulated Embodied Affective-Control

We evaluate the substrate as the perceptual estimator for a simulated embodied agent. The agent maintains a categorical belief b over the affective state, updated by sequential Bayesian accumulation of the per-policy classifier likelihood (Section IV); the environment is action-determined with transition noise, $P(s' | a) = (1 - \epsilon) \mathbf{1}[s'=a] + \epsilon \mathcal{U}$. The loop is a simulation over recorded observations and is not a physical embodiment.

Open-loop, the four streams act as competing observation channels. Under sequential evidence accumulation (Fig. 7),

Brain-inspired reservoir dynamics underlying ARSPI-Net (LIF: $N_{\text{res}} = 256$, $\beta = 0.05$, $\theta = 0.5$; BSC6 window $t \in [10, 70]$)

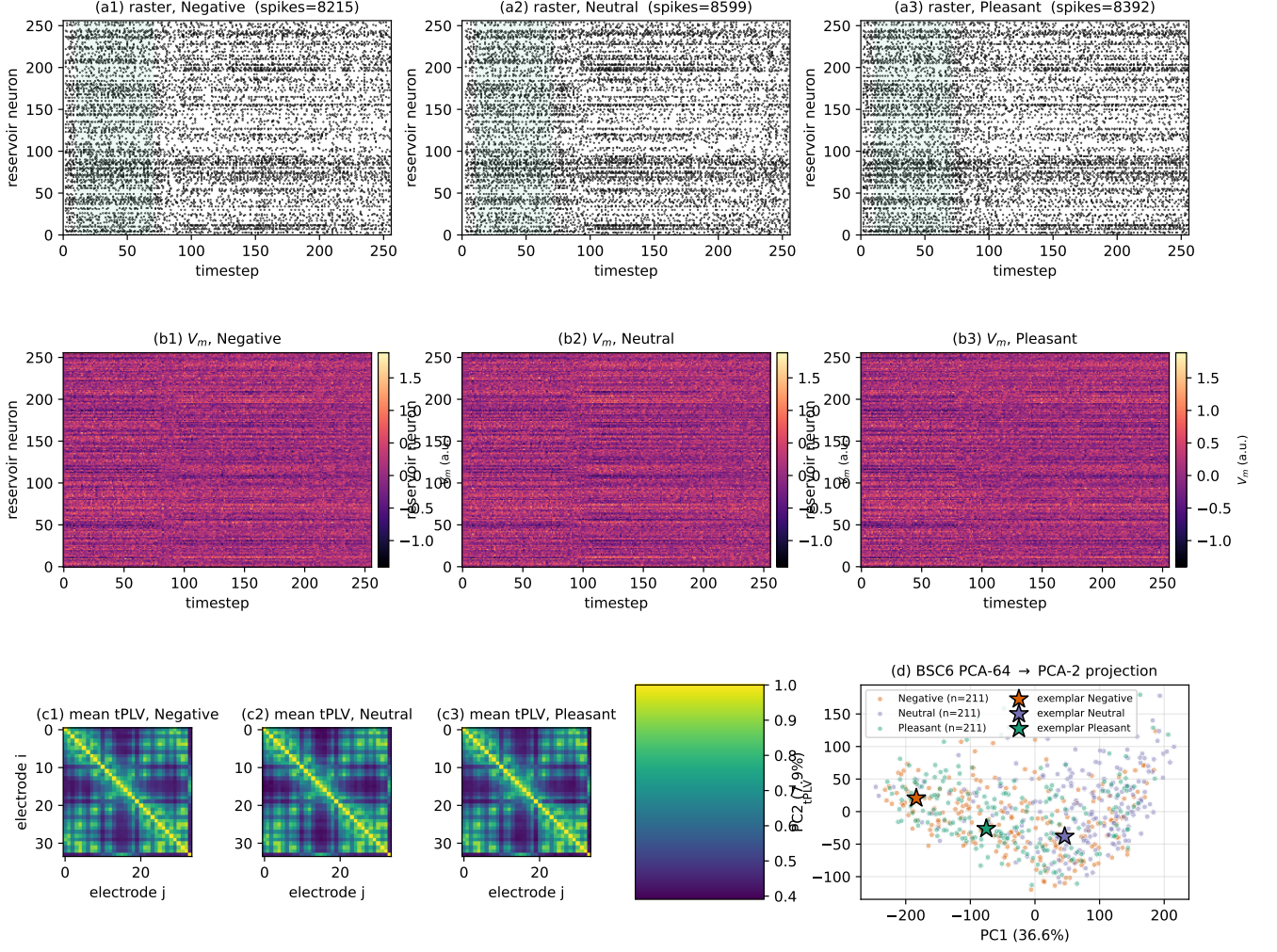


Fig. 4. Computational objects produced by the substrate. (a) LIF spike rasters for one exemplar per affective class on a representative channel; the BSC6 encoding window $t \in [10, 70]$ is shaded. (b) Membrane-potential heatmaps for the same exemplars. (c) Per-class average 34×34 tPLV connectivity matrices across all 211 subjects. (d) BSC6 PCA projection (PC1 vs PC2) coloured by class with the three exemplars marked.

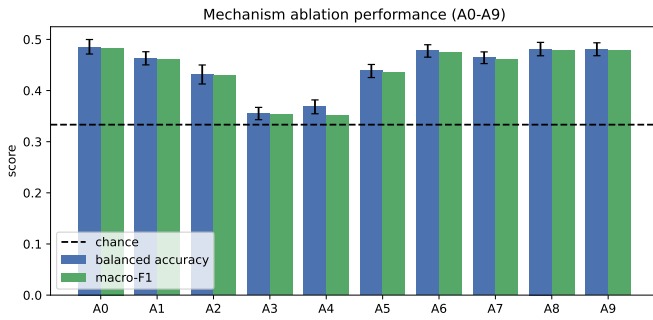


Fig. 5. Mechanism-ablation performance for configurations A0–A9. Balanced accuracy (with bootstrap intervals) and macro-F1 are shown against the three-class chance level. Bars summarise the measured cross-validated performance of each evidence stream and combination.

final posterior entropy ranks them $E+D+T$ (0.931 nats, fastest) $< E$ (0.938) $< D$ (0.957) $< \text{random}$ (1.026) $< T$ (1.075, slowest)—the same ordering as the offline ablation, so the streams’ offline sufficiency and their value as perceptual channels agree.

Closed-loop, the agent must drive the environment to a target affective state and confirm it. An expected-free-energy (EFE) controller selects the action minimising

$$\text{EFE}(a) = \underbrace{\text{KL}(P(s' | a) \| C)}_{\text{risk}} + \underbrace{\mathbb{E}_{s' \sim P(\cdot | a)}[\hat{H}(s')]}_{\text{ambiguity}}, \quad (13)$$

where C is a preference distribution peaked on the target and $\hat{H}(s)$ is the expected observation-posterior entropy for state s estimated on the training fold; the agent stops when $b(\text{target}) \geq 0.8$. It is compared against passive (belief-blind), random, pragmatic-only (risk term only), epistemic-only (ambiguity term only), and a perfect-perception oracle, over 1,500

TABLE V

MECHANISM ABLATION UNDER SUBJECT-GROUPED CROSS-VALIDATION. BALANCED ACCURACY (BA) AND MACRO-F1 ARE REPORTED AS MEAN WITH A BOOTSTRAP 95% INTERVAL. CHANCE BA = 0.333. EACH ROW REPORTS THE FEATURE CONFIGURATION, THE NEURAL MECHANISM IT CARRIES, AND ITS FEATURE DIMENSION.

Cfg	Mechanism	Dim	BA	95% CI	macro-F1
A0	spectral band-power (non-neuromorphic baseline)	170	0.485	[0.471, 0.500]	0.483
A1	LIF reservoir spike embedding (E)	2176	0.463	[0.450, 0.476]	0.460
A2	reservoir dynamical descriptors (D)	238	0.432	[0.413, 0.450]	0.429
A3	tPLV graph topology descriptors (T)	68	0.355	[0.343, 0.367]	0.353
A4	structure-function coupling (C)	3	0.368	[0.355, 0.382]	0.352
A5	D+T (dynamics + topology)	306	0.439	[0.425, 0.451]	0.436
A6	E+D (embedding + dynamics)	2414	0.478	[0.465, 0.490]	0.475
A7	E+T (embedding + topology)	2244	0.464	[0.453, 0.476]	0.461
A8	E+D+T (full reservoir-graph substrate)	2482	0.481	[0.468, 0.494]	0.478
A9	E+D+T+C (substrate + coupling readout)	2485	0.481	[0.468, 0.493]	0.478
CTRL_shuffled_label	negative control	2482	0.335	[0.320, 0.351]	0.333
CTRL_shuffled_subject	negative control	2482	0.474	[0.461, 0.487]	0.471

Robustness degradation by perturbation (representation level)

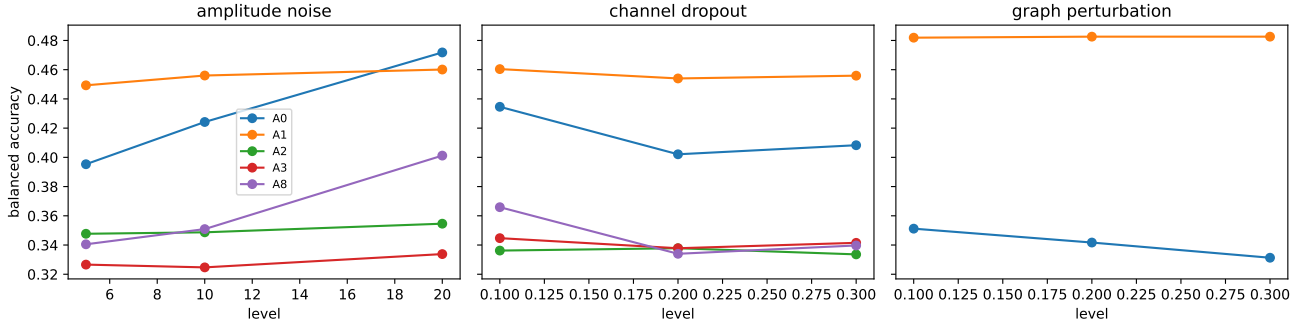


Fig. 6. Representation-level robustness degradation under amplitude noise, channel dropout, and graph edge perturbation for representative configurations. Curves report balanced accuracy as a function of perturbation level; they expose the operating regime of each evidence stream rather than a single endpoint.

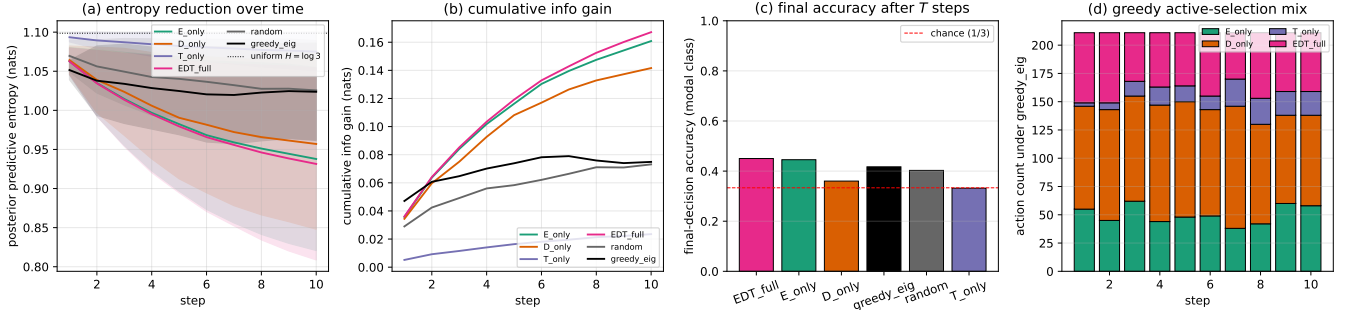


Fig. 7. Open-loop sequential evidence accumulation. (a) Posterior predictive entropy vs. step under each policy (shaded $\pm$ sd across 211 held-out subjects); the dotted line marks the uniform prior $H = \log 3$. (b) Cumulative information gain. (c) Final-decision accuracy (modal class) after $T = 10$ steps; the dashed line marks chance. (d) Action mix of the greedy expected-information-gain meta-policy. The agent's posterior updates over time while its actions do not modify the stimulus stream.

episodes per policy at each transition-noise level ϵ (Table VI, Fig. 8). The oracle bounds success at 1.000. The EFE and pragmatic controllers reach and confirm the target (0.862 and 0.864 at $\epsilon = 0$; 0.805 and 0.808 at $\epsilon = 0.4$), while belief-blind control degrades fastest with transition noise (1.000 $\rightarrow$ 0.733) and the random and epistemic-only baselines stay low. The EFE controller shows no advantage over pragmatic-only control: under an action-determined transition the epistemic term carries little marginal utility, and the gap to the oracle quantifies the cost of single-trial perceptual unreliability. This is an

operating-regime result, not a controller-superiority claim.

E. Reproducibility

Table VII is the reproducibility panel: subjects, observations, classes, channels, split protocol, feature blocks, perturbation families, seeds, closed-loop episodes, policy set, repository/upstream commits, and the restricted-data availability posture. Every main-text quantity maps to a script, input fingerprint, output table, and manifest entry in the reproduction

TABLE VI

CLOSED-LOOP POLICY COMPARISON. SUCCESS RATE (WILSON 95% CI), MEAN STEPS, AND FINAL POSTERIOR ENTROPY BY TRANSITION NOISE ϵ .

Policy	ϵ	Success	Mean steps	Final $\mathcal{H}$
efe	0.0	0.862 [0.844, 0.878]	5.00	0.210
efe	0.1	0.847 [0.828, 0.864]	5.42	0.211
efe	0.2	0.845 [0.826, 0.862]	5.54	0.220
efe	0.3	0.808 [0.787, 0.827]	5.94	0.209
efe	0.4	0.805 [0.784, 0.824]	6.12	0.197
epistemic only	0.0	0.506 [0.481, 0.531]	8.86	0.122
epistemic only	0.1	0.518 [0.493, 0.543]	8.78	0.122
epistemic only	0.2	0.519 [0.494, 0.544]	8.88	0.141
epistemic only	0.3	0.556 [0.531, 0.581]	8.54	0.139
epistemic only	0.4	0.576 [0.551, 0.601]	8.44	0.152
oracle	0.0	1.000 [0.997, 1.000]	1.00	0.000
oracle	0.1	1.000 [0.997, 1.000]	1.07	0.000
oracle	0.2	1.000 [0.997, 1.000]	1.16	0.000
oracle	0.3	1.000 [0.997, 1.000]	1.23	0.000
oracle	0.4	1.000 [0.997, 1.000]	1.37	0.000
passive	0.0	1.000 [0.997, 1.000]	1.00	0.459
passive	0.1	0.937 [0.924, 0.949]	1.00	0.474
passive	0.2	0.873 [0.856, 0.889]	1.00	0.478
passive	0.3	0.802 [0.781, 0.821]	1.00	0.464
passive	0.4	0.733 [0.710, 0.754]	1.00	0.478
pragmatic only	0.0	0.864 [0.846, 0.880]	4.95	0.207
pragmatic only	0.1	0.843 [0.823, 0.860]	5.55	0.209
pragmatic only	0.2	0.850 [0.831, 0.867]	5.45	0.217
pragmatic only	0.3	0.822 [0.802, 0.841]	5.68	0.205
pragmatic only	0.4	0.808 [0.787, 0.827]	6.04	0.206
random	0.0	0.614 [0.589, 0.638]	8.17	0.186
random	0.1	0.625 [0.600, 0.649]	8.20	0.186
random	0.2	0.619 [0.595, 0.644]	8.25	0.186
random	0.3	0.600 [0.575, 0.625]	8.42	0.179
random	0.4	0.625 [0.600, 0.649]	8.10	0.184

TABLE VII

REPRODUCIBILITY PANEL FOR THE EVALUATION. SUBJECT-LEVEL DATA ARE RESTRICTED; RELEASED ARTIFACTS ARE AGGREGATE OR HASHED.

Item	Value
Subjects	211 (subject 127 excluded)
Observations	633
Affective classes	3 (Negative, Neutral, Pleasant)
Channels	34
Split protocol	subject-grouped cross-validation
Feature blocks	BandPower, E , D , T , C
Perturbation types	temporal jitter, amplitude noise, channel dropout, graph
Random seeds	42, 43, 44, 45, 46 (profile: submission)
Closed-loop episodes	≥ 1500 per policy/ ϵ
Policy set	passive, random, pragmatic, epistemic, EFE, oracle
Repo commit	db49b28a02
Upstream commit	6219ab43ef
Data availability	restricted; aggregate/deidentified outputs only

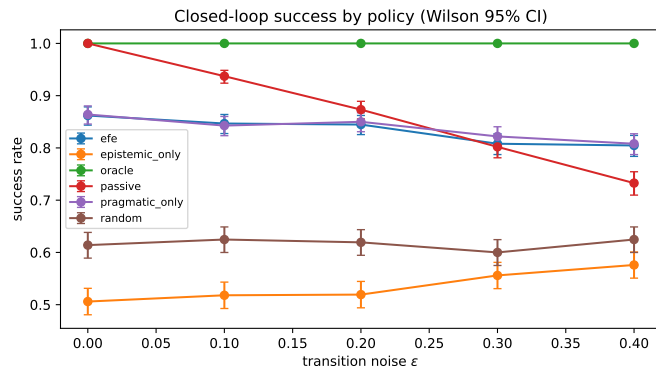


Fig. 8. Closed-loop success rate by policy and transition noise ϵ , with Wilson 95% intervals. The expected-free-energy and pragmatic controllers reach and confirm the target affective state and degrade gracefully; belief-blind, random, and epistemic-only baselines do not match them.

map; the full secondary-evidence record—the ten-fold ablation, clinical and comorbidity models, redundancy analysis, per-condition κ contrasts, and evaluation-coverage and runtime tables—is preserved as the supplementary technical version.

VII. DISCUSSION

A. Main Finding

The four ARSPI-Net blocks are operationally distinct under a fixed evaluation protocol. Affective classification is strongest for embedding-containing configurations and survives subject-respecting permutation testing for 8 of 10 configurations;

standalone T and C do not. Clinical-label sensitivity has a different layer profile in raw means and does not survive BH-FDR across the 30 clinical cells, an outcome a power calculation predicts for a cohort of this size at these effect magnitudes. Pairwise CKA is low to moderate, and the largest pair, $\text{CKA}(E, D) = 0.31$, is well below the value that would mark linear redundancy. κ rejects an electrode-randomised null in roughly one third of observations and is uncorrelated with classifier accuracy, behaving as a complementary systems-level readout. The embodied agent ranks the four feature-stream policies by per-step expected information gain in the same order as the offline ablation. The blocks behave like different signal-processing views of one EEG response. The analyses support claims about operational layer utility, feature-block validity, FDR-corrected affective inference, structure-function coupling against an electrode-permutation null, and the embodied perception-action ranking. They do not support diagnostic or clinical-biomarker claims, because no clinical-label cell survived BH-FDR correction.

B. Why This Is Not Merely an Ablation Table

Ablation in many architecture papers is used to prove that every module raises the final number. That is not the result here. Adding C to $E + D + T$ does not move the affective number. T and C alone are weak affective classifiers under permutation inference. Yet the clinical-label matrix has different best-fit layers for different diagnoses, κ rejects its electrode-randomised null in a substantial subset of observations, and the embodied agent’s per-step expected-information-gain ranking discriminates the streams. A block can be sub-threshold as a classifier and still operationally distinct as a measurement view, and it can carry usable structure for an embodied agent that an offline endpoint metric cannot see.

C. Brain-Inspired Computing for Embodied AI

The brain-inspired claim rests on named mechanisms rather than analogy. The reservoir is a biophysically reduced LIF network [1], [4]; the embedding is a binned spike-count code with a hardware-native counterpart on event-driven substrates [33]; the topology comes from temporal phase-locking

values that have a direct biological reading [23], [24]; and κ measures structure–function coupling of the kind catalogued in network neuroscience [25]–[27]. The embodied claim rests on an implementable sequential-evidence-accumulation protocol whose state update (10) is on-line and requires no end-to-end backpropagation; the loop is closed-loop on the belief side and open-loop on the environment side, and we treat it as a sequential-decision precursor to active inference rather than an active-inference instantiation. The empirical ranking matches the offline ablation: $E + D + T$ is fastest, T -only is slowest. The simulation is a first stage. The next stage is to substitute physiological-feedback actions for our condition-class actions and to run the loop on a neuromorphic accelerator.

D. Implementability on Neuromorphic Hardware

A second reason the ARSPI-Net decomposition is worth taking seriously is that it deploys. The reservoir is fixed, with fewer than 66,000 recurrent weights at $N_{\text{res}} = 256$, and is replicated independently across the 34 EEG channels. Each per-channel reservoir is a 256-neuron LIF population, well below the 8,192-neuron capacity of a Loihi 2 neuro-core [34]; the full $256 \times 34 = 8,704$ -neuron stack therefore fits inside two of the 128 neuro-cores available on a single Loihi 2 chip. The recurrent matrices are not trained on chip and can be loaded as ROM. SpiNNaker offers an analogous mapping with explicit MAP-and-route software support [35]. The intermediate representation is a binned spike count, which event-driven hardware computes natively in on-chip counters. The PCA compression across 34 channels at 64 components per channel sits at roughly 3.34 million scalar weights and is the dominant trainable parameter count; the linear readout adds a further $2,176 \times K$ weights for K output classes. Both projections run host-side on the embedded x86 cores attached to either platform, so re-fitting per subject or per session is a matter of refreshing a small number of weights off the spiking substrate. End-to-end SNN classifiers with millions of synaptic weights on the substrate [9] do not enjoy this property: their entire backbone has to be retrained any time the upstream task changes. A staged neuromorphic architecture in which only the readout adapts is closer to the deployment economics of an embedded system than an end-to-end trainable network is. The reported mappability is a feasibility statement on neuron counts, core counts, and weight counts; a hardware benchmark with on-chip energy and latency measurements is left for future work.

E. Toward Continual Learning and Synaptic Plasticity

The architecture as reported here is static. The reservoir does not adapt and the readout is fitted offline. The closed-loop simulation is open-loop on the substrate side; the agent’s actions modulate which stream it attends to, but no synapse changes. Three concrete extensions preserve the operational-distinctness property while adding biologically motivated adaptation. FORCE learning [5] on the readout weights gives an on-line update rule that is stable in the spectral-radius regime used here. Reward-modulated spike-timing-dependent plasticity [32], [33] on reservoir-to-readout synapses gives a

continual-learning rule that the embodied loop’s own posterior-entropy reduction can drive as a reward signal. Synaptic homeostasis between sessions, applied to the readout only, gives a simple offline consolidation step that prevents unbounded drift of the linear weights. All three extensions are local, none touches the reservoir core, and each can be evaluated against the same operational-distinctness criteria adopted here.

F. Comparison to Brain-Inspired Embodied-AI Architectures

ARSPI-Net occupies a specific corner of the brain-inspired computing landscape. End-to-end spiking classifiers on EEG [9] embed an SNN inside a single trainable pipeline; their architectural blocks are not separately interpretable and their decision is a single endpoint. Reservoir computing for robotic control couples a fixed dynamical reservoir to a low-dimensional motor readout but does not typically expose intermediate measurement layers. Active-inference work in cognitive robotics [29]–[31] treats the perception module as a generative-model black box rather than as a stack of biophysical primitives. ARSPI-Net combines a fixed spiking reservoir, an event-driven code, an electrode-network topology, and a structure–function coupling readout into one stack, audits the stack as a sequence of operationally distinct measurement layers, and exposes the same stack to a sequential-decision simulation as a set of competing perceptual policies. This is the setting in which staged neuromorphic architectures can be defended as multi-stream measurement substrates for embodied AI, rather than as black-box classifiers.

G. Dataset and Methodological Positioning

Three properties separate this study from neighbouring affective-EEG work. The cohort is large by clinical-affective standards, with 211 community-recruited adults, 633 condition-balanced observations, and five overlapping psychiatric labels; most published affective EEG datasets are smaller and recruited from healthy populations. The architecture is a four-block decomposition of a spiking pipeline rather than an end-to-end classifier, and each block is anchored to a named neural mechanism. The audit protocol treats operational distinctness as a measurable property, with permutation inference, FDR correction, redundancy analysis, an electrode-permutation null on κ , and an embodied closed-loop test. None of these on its own is novel; their combination on this dataset, with claims bounded by the FDR result, is.

H. Clinical Interpretation

Clinical findings are bounded. Balanced accuracies between roughly 51% and 56% are not diagnostic performance, and after BH-FDR across the 30-cell matrix none reach significance ($\min p_{\text{BH}} = 0.30$). Two readings remain plausible. The first is transdiagnostic heterogeneity: psychiatric labels may be expressed through distributed temporal, dynamical, and spatial organisations rather than one universal EEG feature space, in which case no single layer-by-diagnosis cell would cleanly separate. The second is statistical: a sample of 211 community-recruited adults with overlapping comorbidity and observed

effect sizes of $\sim 5\%$ over chance is below the power threshold for FDR-corrected detection, and the present analysis fixes the next-step replication target at $N \approx 400$ per diagnosis. Both readings are compatible with the FDR null, and the layer-profile pattern is reported as a directional observation that informs the replication design.

VIII. LIMITATIONS

The scope of this paper is bounded in five specific ways. The embodied evaluation is a closed-loop *simulation* over recorded EEG observations; it is not physical robot embodiment and not live deployment. The clinical analysis is exploratory validation structure only and is not diagnostic validation; no biomarker claim is made. The runtime and resource figures are wall-clock and structural; hardware energy is not measured and no low-power wearable deployment is claimed. The dataset is a private, access-controlled clinical resource, which limits public benchmarking and external replication to approved-access conditions. Finally, all quantitative results are restricted to the measured SHAPE ERP regime and should not be read as universal claims about EEG graph neural networks. The remaining paragraphs detail these bounds.

The clinical labels are comorbid and cannot be interpreted as disorder-specific mechanisms from these analyses alone. After BH-FDR correction across the 30 clinical contrasts no test reaches significance, and the layer-by-diagnosis pattern is reported as a weak-signal observation rather than a discovered biomarker. A power calculation (supplementary technical version) sets the replication target at $N \approx 400$ per diagnosis.

The cohort is cross-sectional and adult. The data span community-recruited participants in a single age band and the analysis is not longitudinal. Architectural maturation, plasticity-driven adaptation, and developmental questions that would otherwise be in scope for a TCDS submission are not addressed by these data and are explicitly excluded from the claims here.

The reservoir is fixed within and across sessions. No synaptic plasticity is implemented. This is the same trade-off that reservoir computing has always made, and it buys interpretability and reproducibility at the cost of adaptivity. The plasticity extensions in Section VII-E are sketched but not evaluated.

The classical ERP baseline reaches 67.2% balanced accuracy on the three-class affective task and ARSPI-Net reaches roughly 49% under the same readout. The gap reflects the ERP feature set’s prior knowledge about affective response components, not a deficit in the brain-inspired stack on its own measurement criteria. The contribution claimed here is the operational-distinctness audit and the embodied test, not endpoint supremacy on the three-class affective task.

The IAPS stimulus set is one of several affective elicitation paradigms. The pipeline has not been evaluated on alternative stimulus modalities (music, video, autobiographical recall), so generalisation outside the IAPS frame is untested.

The embodied demonstration is a simulation, not a robotic implementation. The agent’s state model is a Dirichlet posterior over the held-out subject’s affective response, the exteroceptive features are EEG-derived, and the action set is a

choice over feature-stream policies. A physical-embodiment study would substitute closed-loop sensorimotor feedback for the policy choice, run the loop on a neuromorphic accelerator, and apply continual-learning rules of the kind discussed in Section VII-E. We treat the simulation as a first step that exposes the layer-utility question in an embodied frame and leave the hardware deployment to future work.

IX. CONCLUSION

We asked whether the four blocks of a staged neuromorphic EEG architecture do different things or just rearrange the same information. Under a fixed evaluation protocol and FDR-corrected permutation inference, eight of ten affective configurations exceed chance and standalone T and C do not. Clinical-label cells differ in raw means but do not survive multiple-comparisons correction across the 30-cell matrix; the present analysis reports them as weak-signal sensitivity. CKA between the blocks is low to moderate. κ rejects an electrode-permuted null in 33.5% of observations and behaves as a complementary systems-level readout uncorrelated with classifier accuracy. A sequential-decision simulation that treats the four streams as competing perceptual policies ranks them in the same order as the offline ablation by per-step expected information gain; the loop is closed-loop on the belief side and open-loop on the environment side, and we position it as a precursor to active inference rather than as one. The blocks are operationally distinct, and the architecture supports the brain-inspired-computing-for-embodied-AI framing on grounds of mechanism (LIF spiking, BSC₆ event-driven coding, tPLV connectivity, κ coupling) and on grounds of an embodied closed-loop demonstration. Clinical claims remain bounded by the FDR result. The methodological proposal is to evaluate staged biomedical architectures not by whether each block raises endpoint accuracy, but by what each block measures, how each block behaves as a perceptual stream available to an embodied agent, and how each block deploys on neuromorphic hardware.

DATA AND CODE AVAILABILITY

The analysis code, figure-generation scripts, reproduction map, and changelog that produce every quantitative claim in this paper are maintained in the project repository (link provided under approved-access and review conditions). Raw EEG, clinical metadata, and subject-level feature artifacts are maintained in a restricted research environment. The manuscript reports aggregate, deidentified experimental outputs and methodological details sufficient for reproduction under approved data-access conditions. The SHAPE Community dataset is access-controlled and available from the Laboratory for Clinical Affective Neuroscience at Stony Brook University, subject to approval and a data-use agreement. Aggregate, deidentified results are reported; restricted subject-level data are not publicly distributed and require approved access. Committed prediction-level artifacts use hashed subject identifiers.

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

The authors thank Brady D. Nelson and the Laboratory for Clinical Affective Neuroscience at Stony Brook University for access to the SHAPE Community dataset and for clinical-context discussions, and K. Wendy Tang for advising on the work from which the ARSPI-Net architecture descends. Named acknowledgments are to be anonymized for review and restored on acceptance.

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